The implementation in listing 8.4 supports only a very small subset of elements. But it does demonstrate how well the CoffeeScript syntax can be formed to match your needs. A similar approach can be applied to CSS.

CSS

CSS has traditionally adhered to the principle of least power. Unfortunately, over time least power has turned into insufficient power for many people. The most common approach to tackling the problem has been writing CSS preprocessors such as Less and Sass. CoffeeScript is also a preprocessor, so at a basic level, Sass is to CSS as CoffeeScript is to JavaScript.

An alternative approach to a preprocessor is to embed a DSL in CoffeeScript:

```
emphasis = ->
    fontWeight: 'bold'

css
  'ul':
    emphasis()
  '.x':
    fontSize: '2em'
```

Invoke the css function with the object literal that follows.

The output from this DSL is corresponding CSS:

```
ul {
  font-weight: bold;
}
.x {
  font-size: 2em;
}
```

The need to quote CSS selectors by putting them in strings makes the CoffeeScript DSL more awkward than raw CSS. In the following listing you can see an implementation of a small DSL for CSS.

Listing 8.5. A basic DSL for CSS